

Copyright, Ownership & Licensing

What you may do with these resources, who owns what, and where the licence stops. Written for teachers, faculty leaders and anyone republishing or adapting the suite.

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Commercial use permitted

Attribution required

The short version

You can use this. Freely. Copy it, print it, edit it, put it in your own unit plan, translate it, hand it to a colleague in another state, use it in paid professional learning. You need to do one thing: say where it came from.

What you cannot do is re-license the material that belongs to other organisations. That distinction is the whole point of this document.

1. Ownership

The Swim & Water Safety Teaching Hub — lesson plans, workbooks, posters, scenario cards, rubrics, slide decks, quizzes and this website — was created by **Emilie Harrison**, who holds copyright in the original material.

The suite was developed as an independent project undertaken through a Life Saving Victoria leadership program. It was not produced in the course of employment duties for any school or employer.

Copyright in original literary and artistic works subsists automatically under the *Copyright Act 1968* (Cth). No registration is required in Australia.

2. Licence

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Suggested attribution

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Source: emilie-harrison.github.io/swim-water-safety

If you have adapted the material, say so: “Adapted from ...”. That protects you as much as the author — it makes clear which judgements are yours.

Licence history — why this changed

The repository previously carried a **GNU General Public License v3**. GPL v3 is a software copyleft licence. Its core mechanics — source code distribution, object code, the definition of “the Program” — have no sensible application to lesson plans and PDFs, and its copyleft provisions would have required anyone incorporating a single worksheet into their own unit to release that whole unit under the GPL. Almost no teacher would do that, so in practice the old licence discouraged exactly the reuse it appeared to invite.

CC BY 4.0 was chosen over the NonCommercial and ShareAlike variants deliberately. NC would block Life Saving Victoria, AUSTSWIM or a swim school from using this material in paid professional learning — a legitimate and desirable distribution channel. SA would reintroduce the GPL problem. CC BY also matches ACARA, which licenses Australian Curriculum material under CC BY 4.0, so curriculum content and this suite can be blended without a licence conflict.

CC licences are irrevocable. Material released under CC BY 4.0 stays available under those terms for anyone who received it, even if the licence on this site changes later.

3. What the licence does not cover

Third-party material is excluded

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If you republish an adapted version of this suite, you must carry this limitation forward. Applying a blanket CC BY notice to a package containing third-party content misrepresents what you are entitled to grant.

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Surf Life Saving Australia (SLSA) sls.com.au · beachsafe.org.au	BeachSafe app and website; Summer Coastal Drowning Report 2025/26; red and yellow flag device; Beach Passport	© Surf Life Saving Australia. Publications are expressly copyright — reproduction requires prior permission.	Link to BeachSafe; do not embed or mirror it. Report content requires written permission to reproduce.
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Organisation	Material used in this suite	Their copyright position	What you may do
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Australian Resuscitation Council (ARC) resus.org.au	Resuscitation guidelines underpinning all CPR content — compression rate, depth, ratio, bystander CPR rationale	© Australian Resuscitation Council.	Cite as the clinical source. Do not present ARC guidance as your own or alter the clinical parameters.
World Health Organization who.int	Global drowning fact sheet and statistics used in Year 9–10 international comparison	© WHO, generally CC BY-NC-SA 3.0 IGO.	Note the non-commercial and share-alike terms — these are more restrictive than this suite's own licence.
World Bank data.worldbank.org	Open Data country income classifications (Year 9–10 Extension Q1.3)	© World Bank, licensed CC BY 4.0.	Freely reusable with attribution.
Victorian Department of Education education.vic.gov.au	Policy and Advisory Library; Swimming Instruction and Water Safety Education policy; Respectful Relationships materials	© State of Victoria (Department of Education).	Link to policy rather than reproducing it — policy text changes and a stale copy is a compliance risk.

Organisation	Material used in this suite	Their copyright position	What you may do
Consumer Affairs Victoria consumer.vic.gov.au	Pool and spa fencing legislation referenced in Year 9–10 Extension Q3.2	© State of Victoria.	Link to the current legislation page; requirements change.
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Attribution required inside the files, not just on the site

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Every resource in the suite that quotes drowning statistics now carries the formal citation in its own footer, and that citation is reproduced in the PDF and PowerPoint versions so it travels with a downloaded or emailed file. If you adapt any of these resources, **retain those citations**. Stripping them breaks the condition on which the data is used.

5. Data and statistics

Facts and statistics are not themselves protected by copyright — the expression of them is. You may state that Victoria recorded 52 fatal drownings in 2024–25. You may not reproduce Life Saving Victoria's infographics, charts or report layout.

Statistics throughout this suite are current to:

- Life Saving Victoria, *Victorian Drowning Report 2024–25* (2025)
- Royal Life Saving Australia, *National Drowning Report 2026*
- Surf Life Saving Australia, *Summer Coastal Drowning Report 2025/26* (2026)

Always cite the report and year. Drowning figures change annually and an uncited number rapidly becomes an unverifiable one.

6. AI-assisted development

This suite was developed with AI assistance for research, drafting, formatting and code generation. Educational judgement, curriculum alignment decisions, pedagogical sequencing and final content review are the author's.

The position on copyright in AI-assisted work is unsettled in Australia; the prevailing view is that material requires human authorship to attract copyright protection. The substantive intellectual contribution here — unit structure, curriculum mapping, task design, differentiation decisions — is human. This is disclosed rather than concealed, because teachers evaluating a resource are entitled to know how it was made.

7. If you find an error or a copyright problem

If you believe material in this suite infringes your copyright, or you spot a factual error, contact swimwater.safety@gmail.com. Errors are corrected and republished; anything genuinely infringing is removed.

Every attempt has been made to identify and correctly attribute third-party material. Where that has not been possible, corrections are welcomed.

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Victorian Curriculum F-10 Version 2.0 · Australian Curriculum V9.0 · Health and Physical Education · Levels 7–8 and 9–10

Curriculum codes and wording verified against the VCAA Version 2.0 curriculum export and the ACARA/QCAA published content description sequence, September 2026.

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